CHECKLIST · 5 CHECKS

Five checks before you answer a policy question from memory

A short list any policy owner can run today. No product required.

1. Which document is current?
2. Overlapping approved text?
3. Quoting a section, or email?
4. Show an auditor the text?
5. Willing to say unsupported?

1 CHECK 1 OF 5

Which document is current?

Confirm the live version and the named owner before you answer.

IN PRACTICE

Open the live document. Confirm the owner. Do not answer from last year's email thread.

SIGNAL

If two approved documents disagree, stop and escalate before you answer.

WHY IT MATTERS

If you cannot clear this check, treat the answer as provisional until the library can support it.

2

CHECK 2 OF 5

Is there an overlapping approved document?

Two approved texts that disagree are a governance problem, not a search problem.

IN PRACTICE

Open the live document. Confirm the owner. Do not answer from last year's email thread.

SIGNAL

If two approved documents disagree, stop and escalate before you answer.

WHY IT MATTERS

If you cannot clear this check, treat the answer as provisional until the library can support it.

3

CHECK 3 OF 5

Are you quoting a section, or paraphrasing email?

If you cannot open the section, you are not answering from the library.

IN PRACTICE

Open the live document. Confirm the owner. Do not answer from last year's email thread.

SIGNAL

If two approved documents disagree, stop and escalate before you answer.

WHY IT MATTERS

If you cannot clear this check, treat the answer as provisional until the library can support it.

4

CHECK 4 OF 5

Would you show an auditor the exact text?

If the answer is no, do not treat the reply as authoritative.

IN PRACTICE

Open the live document. Confirm the owner. Do not answer from last year's email thread.

SIGNAL

If two approved documents disagree, stop and escalate before you answer.

WHY IT MATTERS

If you cannot clear this check, treat the answer as provisional until the library can support it.

5 CHECK 5 OF 5

If nothing supports it, will you say so?

An honest unsupported result is better than a fluent guess.

IN PRACTICE

Open the live document. Confirm the owner. Do not answer from last year's email thread.

SIGNAL

If two approved documents disagree, stop and escalate before you answer.

WHY IT MATTERS

If you cannot clear this check, treat the answer as provisional until the library can support it.

CLOSE

Use the list with any library

We built PolicyOps so these checks leave a retrieval trail. The discipline matters either way.

01-02

Current owner and overlaps

03-04

Quote the section; show the auditor

05

Say unsupported when needed

Trail

Keep a record of what was asked